Week-by-Week Plan: August 3, 2026 → ABCC, February 18–22, 2027

Dated execution plan for the HSBI team (finance / innovation / computer science / general business + coach). It operationalizes `preparation_plan.md` and is tuned to the official ABCC rubric — **Implementation & Resources 2.5×, Analysis 2.0×, Recommendation 2.0×** — and to the score weights (traditional 45 %, boardroom 30 %, prepared 25 %). German winter-semester rhythm and the Christmas break are built in. Adjust freely; protect the simulation cadence above all.

Note on phase numbers: the phases here are **calendar phases** and shift slightly against the concept phases of `preparation_plan.md` (its Phase 0–1 ≈ W1–W5 here, Phase 2 ≈ W6–W10, Phase 3 ≈ W11–W26 including the Christmas dip and January peak, Phase 4 = the prepared-case sprint, Phase 5 = taper and competition week). Where the two disagree on a week boundary, this calendar governs.

Contents

- Milestone summary
- Phase 1 — Foundations (W1–W5, Aug 3 – Sep 6) (semester break: flexible scheduling)
- Phase 2 — Skill building (W6–W10, Sep 7 – Oct 11)
- Phase 3 — Simulations under competition rules (W11–W20, Oct 12 – Dec 20) (lectures running: weekend blocks)
- Christmas break (W21–W22, Dec 21 – Jan 3) (light load)
- Phase 4 — Peak (W23–W26, Jan 4 – Jan 31)
- Phase 5 — Prepared-case sprint (W27–W29, Feb 1 – Feb 17)
- Competition week (Feb 18–22, 2027) — operating rhythm
- Debrief (week of Feb 23)

Milestone summary

Date	Milestone
Aug 2026 (now)	E-mail organizers: register interest, confirm eligibility, get on 2027 mailing list
Sep–Oct 2026	Organizer answers logged into the fact base; simulation calendar running
Nov 2026	**Team .pptx template v1 built** (anonymity-proof)
Dec 2026	Template v2 frozen after use in three sims
Late Jan 2027	Taper begins; prepared-case sprint ready to launch
~Feb 4, 2027 (TBA)	**Prepared case released** → 14-day sprint (`preparation_plan.md`, Phase 4)
~Feb 17, 2027 (TBA)	**Prepared-case deck submitted** ≥24 h before the deadline (.pptx by e-mail, "[Team Name] Prepared Case")
Feb 16/17	Fly Bielefeld → Winnipeg
Feb 18–22	**ABCC 2027**
Week of Feb 23	Debrief, thank-yous, handover notes for the next team

Weekly cadence from October: one 3–5 h weekend block (simulation or workshop) + one 60–90 min midweek debrief/skills session + 30 min individual drills (`04-training/business_math_drills.md` routine). **The exercise layer for every week — midweek drills and homework, ~200 solved items — is scheduled in `04-training/exercises/README.md`; it follows this calendar.**

Phase 1 — Foundations (W1–W5, Aug 3 – Sep 6) *(semester break: flexible scheduling)*

Week	Dates	Team session	Materials	Role homework	Admin
W1	Aug 3–9	Kick-off: walk through `08-briefing-slides/abcc_-overview.pdf` + `01-competition/handbook.md`; agree charter & cadence	Deck, handbook	All: read `01-competition/past_-cases.md` Part I	Registration e-mail to organizers
W2	Aug 10–16	Case method 101: reading a case in 30 min, issue trees, MECE, hypothesis-first	`04-training/frameworks.md` §1	All: apply issue tree to one past-case brief	Chase the organizer reply
W3	Aug 17–23	Framework toolkit workshop: strategy, marketing, finance blocks	`04-training/frameworks.md`	Finance: teach-back quick model; CS: case-data attack plan	—
W4	Aug 24–30	Watch + dissect two case-final videos with the official rubric as scoresheet	`01-competition/handbook.md` §7	Innovation: ideation teach-back; GB: pyramid principle teach-back	University funding application
W5	Aug 31–Sep 6	Mini-crack (60 min, no slides): Manitoba Hydro 2023 traditional brief → one-page recommendation	`01-competition/past-case-pdfs/alcc2023_traditional_-manitoba-hydro.pdf`	All: 40-drill baseline test, `04-training/business_-math_drills.md`	—

Phase 2 — Skill building (W6–W10, Sep 7 – Oct 11)

Week	Dates	Team session	Materials	Role homework	Admin
W6	Sep 7–13	Storylining & action titles workshop; build the standard skeleton	`04-training/presentation_-and_storyline_guide.md`	GB: draft team storyline skeleton	—
W7	Sep 14–20	Slide craft + start team .pptx template (16:9, anonymity-proof, no school marks)	Guide §template	CS: template mechanics; Finance: standard financial-exhibit formats	—
W8	Sep 21–27	First full crack, generous 6 h: **re-crack Manitoba Museum 2025 (prepared-style)**; present 25+15 to coach	`01-competition/past-case-pdfs/abcc2025_prepared_-manitoba-museum.pdf`, re-crack brief in `01-competition/past_cases.md`	All: video review, one improvement goal each	—
W9	Sep 28–Oct 4	Q&A bootcamp: answer-first, bridging, quarterback system; first gauntlet	`04-training/qa_drills.md`	All: drill sets by question type	Log the organizers' agenda answers
W10	Oct 5–11	3-min pitch formula + boardroom discussion technique (seated, clicker, invite-the-board)	Guide + `04-training/qa_drills.md`	Rotating opener practice	—

Phase 3 — Simulations under competition rules (W11–W20, Oct 12 – Dec 20) *(lectures running: weekend blocks)*

Every simulation competition-identical: staggered release, timed prep, one laptop per student, internet + GenAI allowed, no coach contact, .pptx to "USB" at pickup time, all four speak, yellow/red cards, rubric scoring into `02-plan/simulation_log.md`.

Week	Dates	Simulation (weekend block)	Materials
W11	Oct 12–18	**Traditional #1 (4 h, softened):** re-crack People Corporation 2025	`01-competition/past-case-pdfs/abcc2025_-traditional_people-corporation.pdf`
W12	Oct 19–25	Debrief + rubric deep dive; implementation-slide clinic (2.5× criterion)	Sim video, handbook §7
W13	Oct 26–Nov 1	**Boardroom #1 (4 h):** re-crack AROW Global 2025 — one slide + one-page brief + 3-min pitch + 22-min grilling	`01-competition/past-case-pdfs/abcc2025_-boardroom_arow-global.pdf`
W14	Nov 2–8	**Traditional #2 (3 h, full rules):** re-crack Access Credit Union 2026 (from re-crack brief)	`01-competition/past_cases.md` §3
W15	Nov 9–15	Debrief; finance clinic: unit economics, sensitivity, payback under time pressure	`04-training/business_math_drills.md`

Week	Dates	Simulation (weekend block)	Materials
W16	Nov 16–22	**Boardroom #2 (4 h):** re-crack Independent Jewellers 2024; freeze template v1	`01-competition/past-case-pdfs/abcc2024_-boardroom_independent-jewellers.pdf`
W17	Nov 23–29	**Traditional #3 (3 h):** original case — **Sparkasse Ostwestfalen** (graded, external judge if possible)	`05-practice-cases/case1_traditional_-sparkasse_youth.md`
W18	Nov 30–Dec 6	Debrief + Q&A gauntlet #2 (hostile set)	`04-training/qa_drills.md`
W19	Dec 7–13	**Boardroom #3 (4 h):** original case — **Manufaktur Lichtwerk** (graded)	`05-practice-cases/case2_boardroom_premium_-brand.md`
W20	Dec 14–20	Half-term review: rubric score trends, role rotation check, gap list for January	`02-plan/simulation_log.md`

Christmas break (W21–W22, Dec 21 – Jan 3) *(light load)*

Individual only: 30-min math drills twice, English case-vocabulary list, one case-final video with rubric.

Phase 4 — Peak (W23–W26, Jan 4 – Jan 31)

Week	Dates	Session	Materials
W23	Jan 4–10	**Prepared-round dress rehearsal (14-day mini-sprint start):** original case — **Klangfest Bielefeld**; workstreams per sprint plan	`05-practice-cases/case3_prepared_-arts_festival.md`
W24	Jan 11–17	Klangfest dress rehearsal 25+15 before external judges; full feedback	Teaching note rubric
W25	Jan 18–24	**Competition-week simulation:** traditional (3 h) Saturday + boardroom (4 h) Sunday, back-to-back, external judges, business attire	Re-crack briefs: Jazz Winnipeg, Coal & Canary, StandardAero/WAG as needed
W26	Jan 25–31	Targeted repairs only; Q&A gauntlet #3; taper begins — no new content after this week	Gap list

Phase 5 — Prepared-case sprint (W27–W29, Feb 1 – Feb 17)

- **Case release expected early February (2025 pattern: 14 days before deadline; exact 2027 date TBA).** Run Phase 4 of `preparation_plan.md`: days 1–2 deep read + client research; 3–5 parallel workstreams; 6–7 storyline + coach review (allowed in this round!); 8–10 deck build; 11–12 dress rehearsals; 13 freeze; **submit ≥24 h before the deadline** (.pptx, "[Team Name] Prepared Case", to aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca — strategist owns submission, coach confirms receipt).
- Keep one light boardroom drill and one 3-h traditional drill mid-sprint to stay sharp; otherwise protect energy.
- Kit check before departure: laptops and chargers, adapters, clicker, backup USB sticks, offline copies of everything including this repository — the list is in `03-team/role_playbooks.md`.

Competition week (Feb 18–22, 2027) — operating rhythm

Day	Expected (2025 pattern; confirm with 2027 guide)	Team protocol
Feb 18	Arrival day; ~17:00 registration + division draw; free evening	Early night; prep-room kit check; prepared-case run-through once, then stop
Feb 19*	Prepared-case presentations + feedback session; evening social	Fixed pre-room ritual; attend feedback, note judge patterns; 15-min debrief max
Feb 20*	Boardroom: staggered 4-h prep + presentations; Festival evening	Tested prep protocol: the six-phase clock in `03-team/role_playbooks.md` (4-h column), rehearsed all autumn; brief finished early — judges read it before we enter
Feb 21*	Traditional: 3-h prep + presentations; finalist announcement; finals; gala	Same protocol, faster; after presenting: immediately pressure-test the deck in case of finals (deck frozen!)
Feb 22	Departure (or finals day if schedule shifts)	Thank-you notes to organizers before leaving

* Round-to-day mapping is **TBA**. The table above assumes the published Feb 18–22 window taken literally (Thu–Mon) with the 2025 round order. All three ABCC-format editions started on a **Wednesday** (2024, 2025, 2026), so 2027 as published would be the first Thursday start — the alternative reading is Wed Feb 17 – Sun Feb 21. The details are in `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md`, "The 2027 weekday question".

Standing rules all week: business professional; **never name HSBI in front of judges**; phones surrendered before prep; the strategist owns the clock; appendix bank feeds Q&A; every debrief ends after 15 minutes; enjoy the social program — judges remember teams they liked.

Debrief (week of Feb 23)

Within ten days: team retro (what the rubric rewarded vs. our assumptions), archive all decks + scores in this repo, write a two-page handover for the next HSBI team, send thank-yous, and update `01-competition/handbook.md` with everything 2027 actually did differently.